GREEN ATLANTIC PVC

November 2026
Keep a copy on the jobsite during installation

Beadboard Installation Guide

Bead Board, Stealth Bead Board, Beaded Planking and beaded sheet

Porch ceilings are the most demanding place to install PVC. The boards are long, the sun heats the ceiling from the outside edge in, and every joist that shows through or every joint that opens is right overhead where everyone sees it. This guide covers the four Green Atlantic beadboard products for ceilings, soffits and wainscot. Read it with the Green Atlantic Trim and Moulding Installation Guide, which covers storage, cutting, sealants and painting.

> **The rules that make a beadboard ceiling stay flat**
> 1. Framing or strapping at 12" on center, or a solid underlayment. 2. A 1/4" gap at every wall, covered by moulding. 3. Fasten every 12" through the tongue or Stealth leg into wood. 4. Glue every end joint with PVC cement and land it on framing. 5. Ventilate the space above the ceiling.

1. The products

Product	Size	Lengths	Fastening edge
GA001 Bead Board	1/2" x 5 1/8"	18'	Tongue
GA002 Stealth Bead Board (white and black)	1/2" x 6"	18' and 24'	Extended Stealth leg
GABP Beaded Planking	3/8" x 5 1/2"	18'	Tongue
Beaded sheet	1/2" x 4'	10' and 20'	Face nailed

All four are thinner than 3/4", so they are fastened with nails. The Starborn screw-and-plug requirement applies to 3/4" to 1 1/4" trim boards and sheets, not to beadboard.

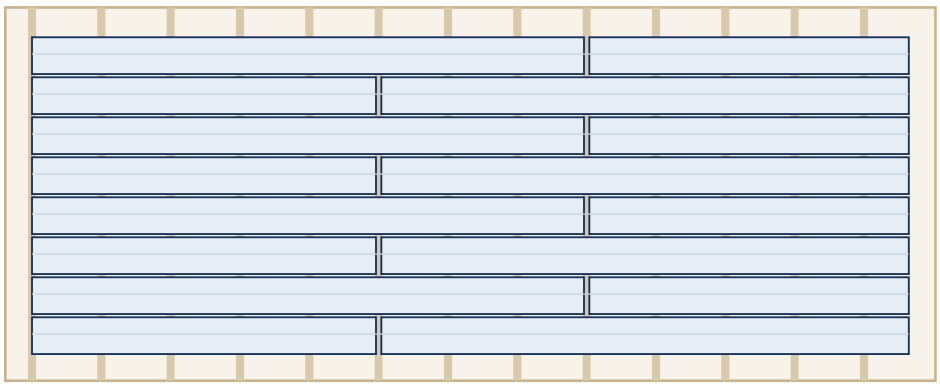
2. Prepare the ceiling

- **Framing at 12" on center or less.** Half-inch and thinner beadboard should not span more than 12". Where joists are 16" or 24" on center, either fur the ceiling with 1x3 strapping at 12" on center, or install a 1/2" or 7/16" plywood or OSB underlayment and fasten through it into the framing.
- **Flat and level.** Shim or plane the framing so the underside is true. PVC follows the framing; it will not hide a crowned joist.
- **Blocking for the trim.** Add solid blocking at the perimeter so the finishing mouldings can be nailed into wood, not into the beadboard.
- **Ventilation.** As with any ceiling, ventilate the space above it to prevent heat buildup. A closed, unvented porch ceiling under a dark roof runs hot.
- **Direction.** Run the boards across the framing so every fastener lands in wood. Where you have a choice, orient the boards the direction that needs the shortest lengths and fewest end joints.

- **Order extra.** Plan on about 5% more than the measured area for cuts and waste.

3. Lay it out

- Measure the ceiling where you will start. Subtract 1/2" from the length of the boards to leave a 1/4" gap at each end.
- Divide the width of the ceiling by the exposed width of the board to find the number of courses. If the last course would be narrower than about 2", rip the first and last boards equally so both edges look intentional.
- Snap a chalk line for the first course parallel to the starting wall, not to the wall itself, which is rarely straight.



Plan view: framing or strapping at 12" on center, staggered and glued end joints, and a 1/4" gap at the walls.

4. Fasteners

Use	Fastener
Through the tongue or Stealth leg	Stainless steel nails with annular (ring) shanks, 2" (8d) long, so they penetrate at least 1 1/2" into wood framing or solid wood backing. A pneumatic finish nailer is the usual tool.
Face nailing (first and last course, beaded sheet)	The same 2" stainless ring-shank nails, set flush.
Adhesive (recommended, in addition to nails)	A construction adhesive rated for PVC, applied to the framing or underlayment. Never use adhesive in place of nails.

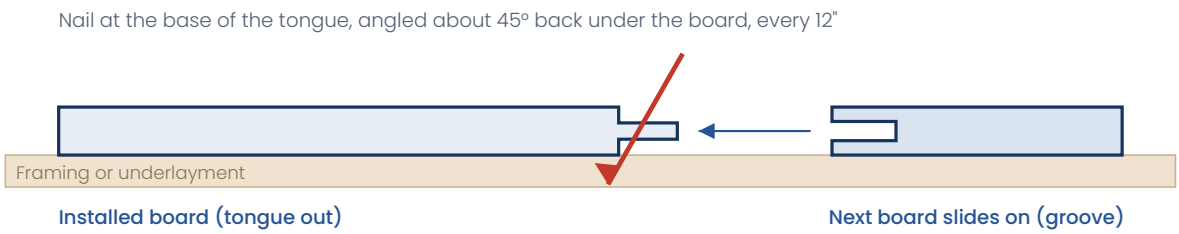
Electro-galvanized and uncoated fasteners will stain and are not acceptable.

5. Install the boards

First course

- Place the first board on your chalk line with the fastening edge (the tongue on Bead Board and Beaded Planking, the extended leg on Stealth Bead Board) facing out into the room, and the other edge 1/4" from the wall. Rip that wall edge off if you need a straight, clean edge.
- Face nail along the wall edge every 12", 1/2" to 3/4" in from the edge, where the moulding will cover the nails. Then nail the fastening edge every 12" as described below.

Each following course



- **Bead Board and Beaded Planking:** nail through the back of the tongue at about 45°, angled away from the tongue, at every framing member or every 12". A nail angled this way will not lift and block the groove of the next board.
- **Stealth Bead Board:** nail through the extended leg every 12", into framing. Set each nail flush so the next board seats fully over the leg.
- Slide the groove of the next board fully over the tongue or leg. If it needs persuasion, tap it home with a hammer and a scrap of beadboard as a block, so the tongue does not mushroom.
- Check the courses against your chalk line every few rows and correct gradually.

Last course

- Rip the last board to width from its fastening edge, leaving 1/4" at the wall. Face nail it every 12", 1/2" to 3/4" from the wall edge, where the moulding will cover the nails.

6. End joints and long runs

- Stealth Bead Board comes in 24' lengths so most porch ceilings go up with no end joints at all. Use the full length wherever you can.
- Where a run is longer than the boards, join them with a 45° bevel or a shiplap joint, glued with PVC cement, landing on framing and fastened on both sides of the joint. Glued joints let the boards move as one piece instead of opening one by one.
- Stagger end joints between courses so they do not line up.
- Installing below 40°F: leave a 1/8" gap at butt ends to allow for warm-weather growth.
- A T moulding, faux beam or coffered layout can hide end joints on very long ceilings.

7. Beaded sheet

- Install beaded sheet over framing at 12" on center or solid underlayment, the same as boards.
- Land every sheet edge on framing. Leave 1/4" at the walls.
- Nail every 12" around the perimeter of each sheet, 1/2" to 3/4" from the edges, and every 16" in the field across the width.
- Cover sheet joints with a batten or T moulding where you want a finished look.

8. Wainscot and walls

- Install over solid sheathing, or add horizontal blocking at 12" on center between studs.
- Keep the bottom edge at least 1/4" above any floor, deck or step that can hold water.
- Fasten through the tongue or leg the same as a ceiling, and finish the top with a cap moulding nailed into blocking.

9. Finishing

- Install perimeter mouldings so they cover the 1/4" gap. Nail them into the blocking or framing, not into the beadboard.
- Fill face nail holes with a filler made for PVC.
- Paint is optional. If you paint white beadboard, use a 100% acrylic latex exterior paint with an LRV of 55 or higher. Black Stealth Bead Board needs no paint; to repaint it, use a heat-reflective paint formulated for vinyl and PVC in a matching black.
- Clean with mild soap and water. Do not pressure wash a ceiling at close range.

Black Stealth Bead Board

Black absorbs more heat than white. On black ceilings, keep framing at 12" on center, use adhesive in addition to nails, and pay particular attention to ventilation above the ceiling.

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The Trim and Moulding Installation Guide, CAD drawings, the product catalog and the limited warranty are available at greenatlanticpvc.com.